



CAUTIONARY NOTES

Chilean Political Landscape Dataset

CPLD · Version 4.0 · 1989-2025

FILE	cpld_v4_0 [.tab/.txt/.csv/.xlsx]
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AUTHOR	Kenneth Bunker
CONTACT	kenneth.bunker@uss.cl
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ABOUT THIS FILE

This file documents methodological decisions, problems identified in the underlying source data, and particular issues that may affect the interpretation of results or distort user calculations for the current version of the CPLD dataset. It is not a record of dataset contents, variable definitions, or version improvements; those are documented in the version update file.

Notes cover edge cases encountered during dataset construction, manual interventions made to resolve ambiguities in the source data, and known discrepancies between official records and the processed data. Where a vote total, seat count, or derived indicator differs from the certified electoral result, the relevant note explains the reason and the adjustment applied. Issues identified and resolved in subsequent versions are flagged in the corresponding version update file. Users working with specific elections, districts, or communes listed below should review the relevant note before drawing conclusions.

NOTES IN THIS VERSION

[01]	IFP exclusion from ENP and polarization
[02]	Region assignment – Diputados district 42
[03]	Region assignment – Senadores circ. 1 & 13
[04]	Total vote-count discrepancy – Senador 1989
[05]	Missing polarization – Alcaldes 2016, 2021 & 2024
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[19]	Nationalization scores are not comparable across election types
[20]	Territorial coverage excludes IFPs

[01] IFP EXCLUSION FROM ENP AND POLARIZATION

Independientes Fuera de Pacto (IFP) are excluded from the computation of the effective number of parties (`enpv_national`, `enps_national`) and from ideological polarization (`polarization_district`, `polarization_national`). In elections with a substantial IFP presence, this exclusion causes these indicators to understate fragmentation and may cause polarization indices to diverge from what a full-distribution measure would produce.

[02] REGION ASSIGNMENT – DIPUTADOS DISTRICT 42

Electoral district 42 was split between two regions as a result of regional boundary changes. It has been manually assigned to region 16 in the `region_2024` variable for all elections in which it appears.

Diputados · District 42	→ Region 16 (Ñuble)
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[03] REGION ASSIGNMENT – SENADORES, CIRC. 1 & 13

Two senatorial circunscripciones were affected by regional boundary changes. These assignments apply to Senadores elections from 1989 through 2013.

Circ. 1 · Arica y Tarapacá	→ Region 15 – leaves region 1 (Tarapacá) unrepresented before the change
Circ. 13 · Bio-Bio Cordillera	→ Region 8 – leaves region 16 (Ñuble) unrepresented before the change

[04] TOTAL VOTE-COUNT DISCREPANCY – SENADOR 1989

Source-data vote totals for four circunscripciones do not reconcile with certified results.

Circ. 4 · IV, Coquimbo	missing 149 valid votes
Circ. 9 · VI, O'Higgins	missing 308 valid votes
Circ. 12 · VIII, Biobio	missing 75 valid votes
Circ. 17 · X, Los Lagos	159 extra valid votes

[05] MISSING POLARIZATION – ALCALDES 2016, 2021 & 2024

The variable `polarization_district` is missing for six communes across three mayoral elections. In each case every list competing in the commune was an Independiente Fuera de Pacto. IFPs are excluded from the polarization computation (see note 1), so no scored list remains and the index cannot be computed. Loncoche 2021, for example, was contested by five candidates, all of them IFPs.

2016	Illapel, Lolol
2021	Loncoche, Quilleco
2024	Empedrado, Santa Juana

[06] MISSING ETHNIC DATA – FOUR COMMUNES

The variable `ethnic_number` is missing for Alto Biobío, Alto Hospicio, Cholchol and Hualpén in every municipal election in which they appear, 48 rows in total. All four communes were created in 2004, after the 2002 census that supplies the indigenous population and total population counts behind this variable. Note that `ethnic_frac` is populated for these same rows because it is drawn from a different source, so the two ethnic measures do not share the same coverage, and a model using both will lose these rows only through `ethnic_number`.

[07] UNFLOORED DIF2 IS NEGATIVE IN 97 ROWS

`dif2` is stored as $\max(0, \text{enpv} - \text{enps})$. In 97 rows `enps` exceeds `enpv`, so the stored value is zero rather than the true negative difference. This is a property of integer seat allocation, which can distribute seats more evenly than votes were distributed, and not a rounding artefact. A six-seat council splitting 2-2-2 on vote shares of 45/30/25 yields ENPs of 3.00 against ENPv of 2.83. The affected rows concentrate in Concejales (33), Municipales 1996-2000 (31), Diputados 1989-2013 (14) and Municipales 1992 (11). Users who need the signed quantity should compute `enpv - enps` directly.

[08] COX_SHUGART IS NOT COMPUTED BELOW THREE LISTS

Cox_Shugart is missing in 492 rows, every unit contested by fewer than three lists. Most of them are Alcaldes comunas, 382, with the rest spread across Municipales, Gobernador second rounds and a handful of legislative districts.

The reason is that the index is a regression slope and a regression through two points is not an estimate. With two lists b reduces exactly to $(s1 - s2) / (v1 - v2)$, and in a single-seat race, where the winner takes the only seat, that is one over the winner's margin. It therefore grows without bound as the contest tightens. Zapallar in Alcaldes 2016 was almost a dead heat and returned 4,091. Before the restriction, the 483 two-list rows had a median of 4.39 against 1.46 for units with three or more lists, and 131 of them exceeded 10. A few hundred near-tie artefacts would have driven any model fitted on the column.

Nothing is lost. A two-list unit that gives all its seats to one list is already at the maximum of both LH and Gallagher, which is where that information belongs.

The instability is reduced, not eliminated. A near-tied three-list unit can still return a large value, and the largest in the released file is 20.42, Sierra Gorda in Alcaldes 2021. Across the 5,627 rows that carry a value the median is 1.46 and the standard deviation 0.95, so the tail is thin, but inspect the variable before fitting on it.

Where three or more lists ran and every one of them won an equal number of seats, the seat share is flat and the slope is a genuine zero. Eight rows. Some of these are also among the 97 described in note 7, for the same underlying reason.

[09] SEAT PRODUCT IS NOT COMPARABLE ACROSS ELECTION TYPES

sp is computed as $dm \cdot as$, and as is the size of the assembly to which the unit's seats belong. Because assemblies are constituted at different territorial levels, as is 1 for Alcaldes and Gobernadores, the comuna council size for Concejales and Municipales, the regional council size for Cores, and the full nationally contested chamber for Diputados, Senadores and Constituyentes. sp is therefore comparable within an election type but not across types. A pooled model spanning types should be built on **as2**, which is defined identically for every election. See the codebook entries for as and as2.

[10] SEAT CORRECTIONS – MUNICIPALES 1992

Four communes produced IFP seat over-allocations in the 1992 municipal election; seats were manually corrected.

Coltauco	IFP 1 · Participación y Progreso 1 · Concertación 4
Frutillar	IFP 1 · Participación y Progreso 2 · Concertación 3
Lebu	IFP 1 · Participación y Progreso 2 · Concertación 2 · Partido Comunista 1
Quemchi	IFP 1 · Participación y Progreso 2 · Concertación 3

[11] SEAT CORRECTIONS – MUNICIPALES 1996

Two communes produced IFP seat over-allocations; seats were manually corrected.

Alhué	IFP 1 · Unión por Chile 2 · Concertación 3
Concon	IFP 1 · Unión por Chile 2 · Concertación 3

[12] SEAT CORRECTIONS – MUNICIPALES 2000

Four communes produced IFP seat over-allocations; seats were manually corrected.

Alhué	IFP 1 · Alianza por Chile 2 · Concertación 2 · La Izquierda 1
Concon	IFP 1 each (×2) · Alianza por Chile 2 · Concertación 2
Graneros	IFP 1 · Alianza por Chile 2 · Concertación 3
Pinto	IFP 1 · Alianza por Chile 4 · Concertación 1

[13] SEAT CORRECTIONS – CONCEJALES 2008, CURACAVÍ

One commune produced an IFP seat over-allocation; seats were manually corrected.

Curacaví	IFP – Juan Pablo Barros Basso 1 · Concertación Democrática 3 · Alianza 2
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[14] SEAT CORRECTIONS – CONCEJALES 2021

Three communes produced IFP seat over-allocations; seats were manually corrected.

Coquimbo	IFP – Pablo Galleguillos Castillo 1 · Chile Digno Verde y Soberano 3
Puerto Varas	IFP – Rocío Alvarado Díaz 1 · Chile Vamos UDI-Indep. 1
Putendo	IFP – Francisco Casas Muñoz 1 · Chile Vamos UDI-Indep. 1

[15] SEAT CORRECTION – DIPUTADOS 2021, DISTRICT 28

The D'Hondt algorithm over-allocated seats in district 28 due to a tie involving an IFP candidate. The certified seat allocation is reflected in the dataset; the raw D'Hondt output was not used.

Diputados · District 28

IFP – Carlos Bianchi Chelech 1 · Apruebo Dignidad 1

[16] TIE-BREAKING – ALCALDES 2008, TIMAUKEL

One commune produced a tied result involving two candidates. To resolve the seat allocation, votes were added. Vote totals for these candidates do not match certified electoral results.

Timaukel+1 vote – Atilio Fabián Gallardo Bustamante · +10 votes –
Carlos Enrique López Vega

[17] TIE-BREAKING – ALCALDES 2016, HUARA

One commune produced a tied result. Because the D'Hondt seat allocation algorithm cannot resolve a zero-vote tie, one vote was added to allow seat assignment. The vote total for this candidate does not match the certified electoral result.

Huara+1 vote – José Andrés Bartolo Vinaya → breaks zero-vote
tie

[18] TIE-BREAKING – CONCEJALES 2024, COCHRANE

One commune produced a tied result, with the list “Tu Comuna Radical” sharing 26.9% of the vote with another list. Because the D'Hondt seat allocation algorithm cannot resolve a zero-vote tie, one vote was added to allow seat assignment. The vote total for this list does not match the certified electoral result.

Cochrane

+1 vote – list “Tu Comuna Radical” → breaks 26.9% tie

[19] NATIONALIZATION SCORES ARE NOT COMPARABLE ACROSS ELECTION TYPES

Caution: `Mainwaring_Jones` and `pns_weighted` are Gini-based, and Gini-based scores fall as the number of territorial units rises (Bochsler, 2010). Units in this dataset range from 7 (Senadores) to 345 (Alcaldes), so differences between election types on these two variables largely reflect unit count.

Use `pns_standardised` for comparisons across election types. It removes most, but not all, of the unit-count effect. It is anchored at ten units, so values for senate cycles (about four effective units) are extrapolated. Where possible, compare within an election type.

[20] TERRITORIAL COVERAGE EXCLUDES IFPS

`territorial_coverage` counts only lists, and IFP candidates are excluded from it as from every other measure in that section. In elections where independents are a large share of the field this understates how much of the country saw some candidate on the ballot. Alcaldes 2024, where independents were 44 per cent of candidates, is the clearest case.

ACCESS THE DATASET



SCAN FOR THE PROJECT PAGE

labdemgob.github.io/cpld

Downloads, codebook, version history, and replication materials for the CPLD.

MAINTAINER	Kenneth Bunker
LABORATORY	Laboratorio Democracia y Gobierno
FACULTY	Economía, Negocios y Gobierno
UNIVERSITY	Universidad San Sebastián
LOCATION	Santiago, Chile
CONTACT	kenneth.bunker@uss.cl
REPOSITORY	github.com/labdemgob
DATAVERSE	doi.org/10.7910/DVN/NGRY3R
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